

SAFETY ALERT

OISD/SA/2023-24/P&E/01

Dt.:21/04/2023

INTRODUCTION

Title: Fatal accident due to pipe rollover during unloading of pipes in pipe yard.

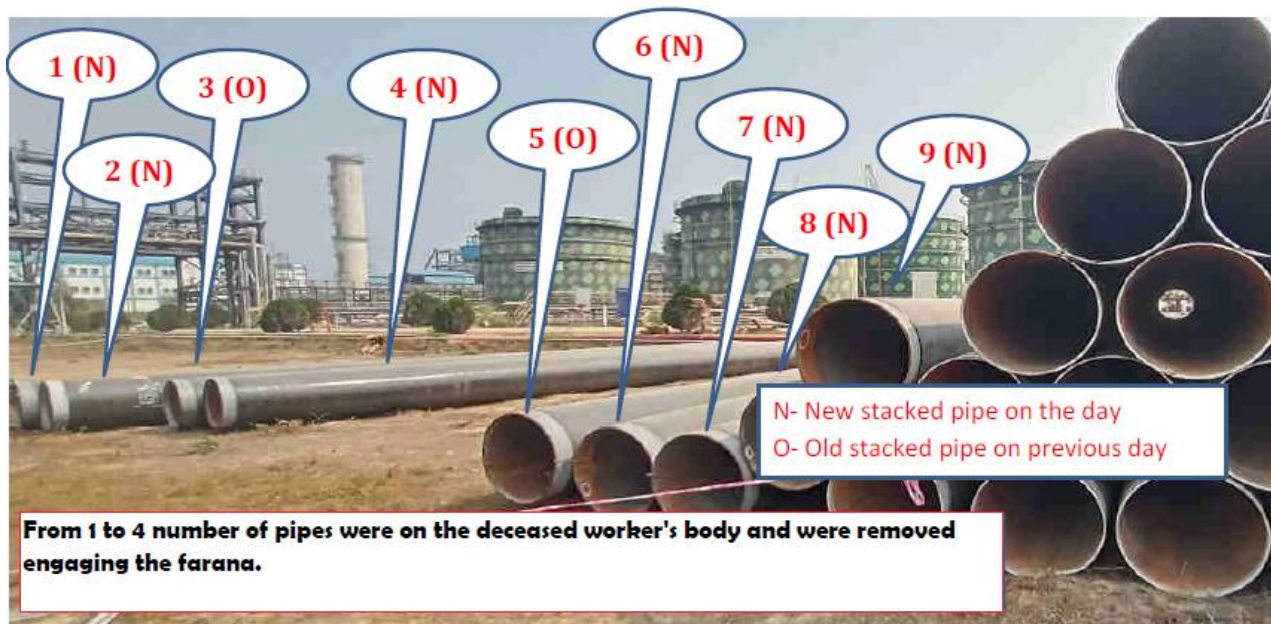
Location: Pipe storage yard in Refinery.

Loss/ Outcome: Fatality of one contract worker.

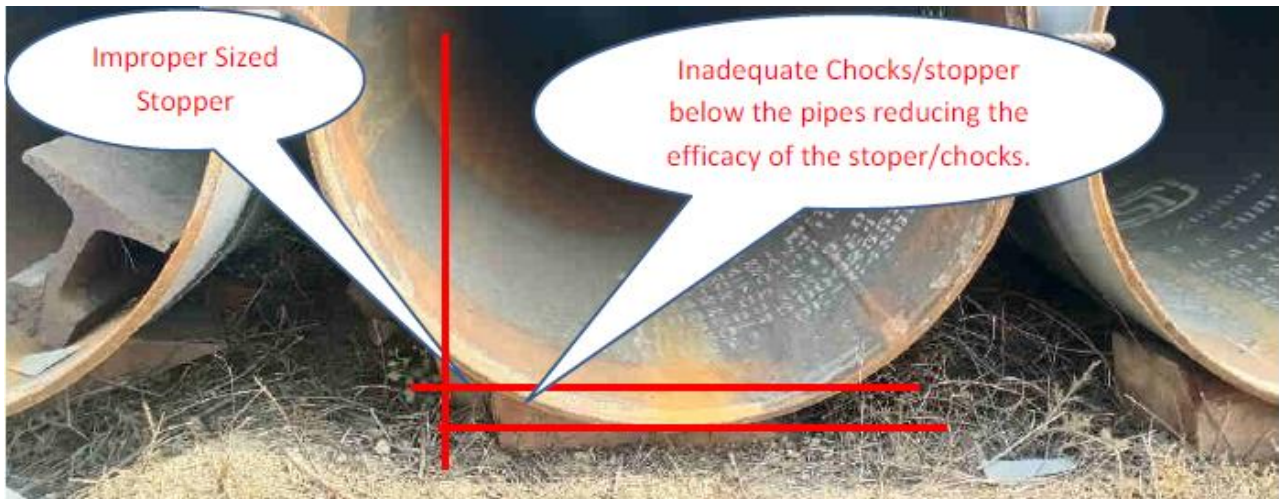
BRIEF OF INCIDENT:

The Incident happened when unloading of pipes (NB 24 inch) was being done in pipe yard. Pipes were stacked and lifting of pipe was being done by 17MT Farana crane. During this activity few pipes (9 No.) rolled off from pipe stack and rolled over a contract worker engaged in the unloading work. Four number of pipes rolled over victim while his leg got trapped in one of the rolled pipe. The injured workman was shifted to the hospital, and he had been declared brought dead in the hospital.

PICTURE: NUMBER PIPE ROLLED DURING ROLL OFF:



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OBSERVATIONS/ SHORTCOMINGS

- Deceased person was inexperienced for this job, it was his first day for pipe unloading job. He had undergone mandatory safety training for gate pass purpose, but not undergone any toolbox talk for such job.
- The ground where pipe stacking was done was not levelled/ graded and was uneven.
- Some of chocks/ stoppers were observed not adequate to perform its function. The gap between the grade and bottom of the pipe were uneven and in one case the chock/ stopper was below the pipe.
- There was no procedure available for stacking, unloading of pipe.
- There was no supervision during stacking and unloading activity.

REASONS OF INCIDENT / ROOT CAUSE

- Uneven surface of storage yard.
- Inadequate pipe stoppers/ chocks.
- Engagement of unexperienced worker.
- Lack of supervision and lack of risk perception.
- Toolbox talk was not conducted by which safety measures and risks could be communicated.

RECOMMENDATIONS

- A SOP shall be framed for pipe unloading and stacking mentioning the required manpower skill level, maximum stacking height, maximum numbers of layers of pipes, wedge/ Chock dimension.
- Pipe stack yard surface shall be made even and levelled properly prior to unloading & stacking.
- Stoppers with steel pipe/ RCC pole shall be positioned on both sides of stacked pipe after stacking the bottom layer pipes.

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- Adequate chokes shall be placed on outermost bottom layers of pipes. Only after stacking and choking of bottom layer pipe, the subsequent layer shall be stacked.
- Barricading shall be done to indicate the line of fire, and no one shall be allowed to enter the barricade and there should be mandatory deliberation about line of fire during toolbox talk (TBT).
- Toolbox talk shall be conducted before starting the job at work location and necessarily discuss all the points which were captured during the JSA and about safeguard taken, DOs -DON'Ts. Additional points may also be discussed and recorded during TBT and additional safeguard shall be taken as per TBT before starting the work. On job training to be given to new/ inexperienced person.
- Job shall be started only after obtaining necessary work permit from the area owner after fulfilment of all JSA Points. Different permit to be issued for same job at different location.
- Contractor shall ensure that jobs are executed as per the SOP (Safety Operating Procedure) which were developed and approved by competent authority and JSA for the work which shall be applicable for individual location.
